

Proposal for A Future for the Office Leased at 1015 S. 4th St., Louisville, KY

Submitted to the Libertarian Party of Kentucky

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Within the context of establishing a county party in Louisville/Jefferson county, I have determined that the office that the Libertarian Party of Kentucky is leasing in Louisville would be a valuable asset that could catalyze the growth and image of this county affiliate.

I have spoken face to face with the owner/landlord of the property. He is supposed to be getting us a copy of the current lease. I reached out to him again today, as I have not heard back from him yet, and am running out of time (assuming there even still is any).

While briefly discussing the situation with him, 2 salient points arose. First, he is willing to work with us going forward should we choose to retain the office space. Second, he has had no issues with us, so we are not working against a bad impression of us.

Regarding the value of this space to a Jefferson County affiliate, a few points are apparent to me

1. **A Substantial Image:** This is evident to me coming from the animal rescue world. Rescues who have facilities are taken more seriously than those who do not, by default. Our animal rescue (No-Kill Louisville) has a facility, and we are taken more seriously partially due to that.
2. **Private Meeting and Work Space:** Restaurants are fun for social events, but much of what I intend to be doing is not suitable for that sort of environment. A quiet, professional space setup specifically for party work is what this would provide us with. It would be nice to not have to operate the county party like a home-based-business.
3. **Media Engagement Location:** A controlled environment where candidates, party members, the media, volunteers, or the public can interact with one another in "party territory."
4. **Campaign and Candidate Support:** During campaign season, the office could easily be used as a campaign headquarters, taking advantage of the above three points and concentrating them on the campaign(s).
5. **Storage:** We do need a place for asset storage.

Financing

We will be working to increase party membership in Jefferson County as an initial priority. As ramping up will take some period of time, I propose that the $\frac{2}{3}$'s of dues that would return to the Libertarian Party of Louisville, as a county affiliate, received from Party Members residing in this county, be used in whole to pay for that amount of the rent on the office, the balance being temporarily covered by the state party.

I believe that having this space will be useful in bringing on new members to the State Party for the reasons listed above. Increasing membership from this county such that the State Party no longer needs to cover any costs on that asset, and the Libertarian Party of Louisville can assume full responsibility for it, would be a primary initial goal for the Libertarian Party of Louisville to pursue.

I doubt a renewed lease would be for the current \$450 per month. I did not discuss any details with the landlord, but he seemed unconcerned about the whole thing, frankly, and did indicate that he would work with us.

Conclusion

This may all be moot, depending on time and circumstances, but I do think this would help me bootstrap a county affiliate here in Louisville. I appreciate your consideration of this proposal.

Sincerely,
Jeremy Daniel Ficklin
Louisville, KY